

Alexander Wornast

SENIOR DATA ENGINEER

☎ +44 7529 606576 | ✉ alex.wornast@karasuintelligence.com | 📱 tetracionist | 💻 alexander-wornast | 🏠 tetracionist.substack.com | 📍 Farnborough, UK

Senior data engineer with nearly 11 years working in data. At Clekt, a specialist Snowflake consultancy, I act as a technical lead on client engagements, owning the technical solution end to end: discovery and source-system analysis, design, build, deployment and production support. I have worked with clients in the utilities, retail, travel and defence spaces. SnowPro Core certified, with experience in dbt Core. I work AI-assisted day to day (Claude Code, Snowflake CoCo) and own the architecture and code review on every engagement.

Work Experience

Clekt | Specialist Snowflake Consultancy

Remote, UK

SENIOR DATA ENGINEER

Feb. 2025 — Current

- **Technical lead** for a retail client's migration from Redshift to Snowflake, built on dbt Projects on Snowflake, which saves the client £400,000 a year in vendor fees
- Tech-led an **invoice-automation** engagement that replaced a manual, document-heavy process with an automated Snowflake pipeline covering 90 bookmakers, each with their own bespoke input format; designed metadata-driven Excel ingestion patterns with Snowflake directory tables
- Led Hotelplan Inntravel's **data migration** from a legacy MS SQL Server booking system to the Lemax SaaS platform; used Jaro-Winkler fuzzy matching to link records where reliable keys were missing
- Built two **AI proofs-of-value** on Snowflake Cortex: document search over PDF content (hybrid vector and keyword retrieval), and sentiment analysis over patient free-text data with semantic views and a natural-language query front end using Snowflake CoWork
- Sat with clients in **discovery** and won the build work on three sports and gambling engagements, covering data engineering, platform setup, and ML and automation architecture
- Run **L3 support** for client production platforms under contractual SLAs; audited five client Snowflake accounts against the **CIS Benchmark** and walked each client through what to fix first
- Hold **code-review and deployment standards** across engagements and mentor the engineers I work alongside

Superscript | UK InsurTech

London, UK

SENIOR DATA ENGINEER

Mar. 2023 — Jan. 2025

- Promoted from Data Engineer (Jul. 2024); **co-owned the entire data platform** with one other engineer, where underwriting models score real-time event data from the policy administration system
- Built and ran the **ELT from production Postgres into Snowflake**: incremental extraction, cleansing and dbt modelling into reporting marts used daily by underwriting, finance and leadership
- Built the **MLOps setup on Amazon SageMaker** with the data science team: containerised endpoints and automated retraining for five production models, taking deployment from a multi-week manual process to scheduled runs
- Cut warehouse compute time by about 1.5 hours using dbt slim builds and defer; led the dbt 0.8 to 1.5 and Prefect 2 to 3 upgrades, which lowered the pipeline failure rate
- Owned day-to-day **reliability**: Datadog alerting into Slack on source feeds and jobs, plus incident response and root-cause analysis
- Moved memory-hungry Python pipelines off Heroku onto **AWS ECS / Fargate** (provisioned with Terraform), and introduced GitHub Actions CI/CD gating that blocked production deploys without a green test run
- Owned code-review standards and **mentored three engineers**

Aiimi Ltd | Utilities & Defence Consulting

Milton Keynes, UK

DATA ENGINEER (CONSULTANT)

Jan. 2022 — Feb. 2023

- Client-facing consultant delivering pipelines and lakehouse platforms on-site for UK water utilities (Northumbrian Water, Anglian Water, Severn Trent) and a defence client
- Cut Northumbrian Water's **visible-leak response time from five days to three**, meeting the Ofwat ODI regulatory target, by joining up weather, field-worker, CRM and call-centre data in Azure Data Factory and Databricks (PySpark)
- Built a secure, configurable MS SQL Server 2019 database for a UK **defence client on airgapped hardware**, with a parameter-driven schema that could keep up with shifting operational-asset requirements; wrote the documentation and ran the handover training on-site

Allianz UK | Insurance

Guildford, UK

DATA ENGINEER

Oct. 2015 — Dec. 2021

- IT Technical Apprentice, then Trainee Solution Analyst (Mar. 2017), then Data Engineer (Jul. 2021); six years primarily on the SAS data warehouse, then the Global Data Platform on **Azure** (Databricks, Data Factory, Synapse) from 2021
- Delivered the **most detailed pricing dataset in Allianz UK's history** (849 columns across 15 million rows), letting actuarial and pricing teams assess claim propensity at policy-line level for low-profitability products
- Worked with Allianz Group on the **Data Vault 2.0** Common Ingestion Model and partnered with the Group company in Germany on a cross-border liability-insurance data transformation
- Delivered a product change for the Construction Select engineering product with a reusable SAS macro and validated around 300 downstream tables with minimal downtime
- General ledger data **SME** for mid-corporate and liability products; helped actuarial, pricing and finance stakeholders make sense of source-system data

Education

Avado Learning DATA ANALYST APPRENTICESHIP (DISTINCTION)	UK 2020 - 2021
City & Guilds, QA Apprenticeships LEVEL 4 DIPLOMA IN ICT PROFESSIONAL COMPETENCE (DISTINCTIONS IN SQL & JAVA)	London, UK 2017
City & Guilds, QA Apprenticeships LEVEL 4 DIPLOMA FOR ICT PROFESSIONALS: SYSTEMS & PRINCIPLES	London, UK 2017
Sackville School A-LEVELS: COMPUTING & MATHEMATICS; AS-LEVEL PHYSICS	East Grinstead, UK 2015

Certifications

Dec. 2025 **SnowPro Core**, Snowflake
Apr. 2026 **Claude API, Claude Code in Action, MCP, Agent Skills**, Anthropic Academy
Jul. 2018 **BCS Systems Modelling Techniques**, BCS
Jun. 2018 **SAS Certified Base Programmer (SAS 9)**, SAS
Mar. 2016 **ISTQB Foundation in Software Testing**, ISTQB

Skills

Consulting & Delivery	Client discovery & requirements, technical solution ownership, full-lifecycle delivery L3 support under contractual SLAs (Jira Service Desk), documentation & handover training, mentoring & code-review standards
Snowflake	SnowPro Core certified; Snowpark, Streams & Tasks, Dynamic Tables, Snowpipe / Snowpipe Streaming, directory tables Cortex (Search, AI sentiment, semantic views), cost governance (warehouse right-sizing, resource monitors), security (CIS benchmark audits, masking & row-access policies)
dbt	dbt Core & dbt Projects on Snowflake; slim builds & defer, custom tests, dbt-expectations, Elementary
Programming Languages	Python, SQL, PySpark / Spark SQL, Snowpark, TypeScript, Bash, SAS (legacy estates)
Processing & Orchestration	Apache Spark (Databricks / Delta Lake), Airflow, Prefect v2 & v3 (led v2 to v3 upgrade), Azure Data Factory, Snowflake Tasks
Cloud & DevOps	AWS (S3, ECS / Fargate, SageMaker, IAM), Azure (Data Factory, Databricks, Synapse, ADLS) Docker, Terraform, GitHub Actions CI/CD, DLSync
ML & AI	Amazon SageMaker MLOps (5 models productionised), Snowflake Cortex, MCP servers & Claude API, entity resolution & fuzzy matching (Jaro-Winkler)
Quality & Governance	dbt tests, Great Expectations, Elementary, Datadog + Slack-integrated alerting, PII handling in regulated environments

Open Source & Writing

DLSync	Contributor: CI/CD deployment tooling for Snowflake objects
sqlfluff-action	Author: TypeScript GitHub Action for SQL linting
productive-io-mcp-server	Author: Model Context Protocol server for the Productive API
Field Notes	Essays on data engineering and architecture, incl. <i>The thinking, not the tooling</i> ; <i>The Cuckoo Architecture</i> ; <i>Load it first, ask questions later</i>